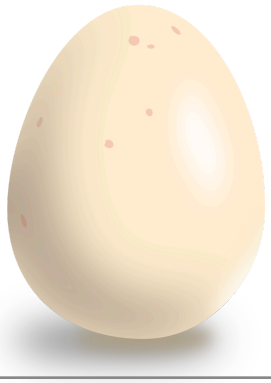


Aa

Short sound /ah/

Long sound /A/

a_e	c<u>ake</u>
ea	gr<u>ea</u>t
ei	r<u>ei</u>gn
ey	th<u>ey</u>
eigh	<u>eigh</u>t
a |	<u>a</u>corn

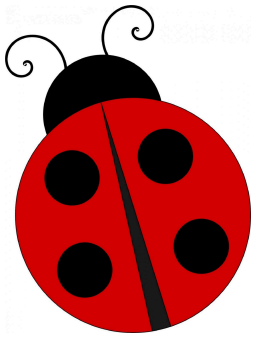


Ee

Short sound /eh/

Long sound /E/

e_e	th<u>eme</u>
ee	tr<u>ee</u>
ea	s<u>ea</u>
i_	rad<u>io</u>
y	bab<u>y</u>
i	taxi
ie	brown<u>ie</u>
e	<u>e</u>raser

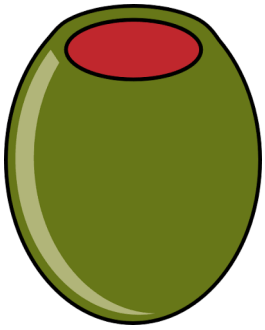


Ii

Short sound /ih/

Long sound /I/

i_e	k<u>ite</u>
y	m<u>y</u>
igh	l<u>igh</u>t
ie	t<u>ie</u>
ei	h<u>ei</u>ght
i |	pr<u>i</u>vate



Oo

Short sound /aw/

Long sound /O/

o_e	n<u>ote</u>
ow	l<u>ow</u>
oa	b<u>oa</u>t
oe	t<u>oe</u>
o	<u>o</u>pen

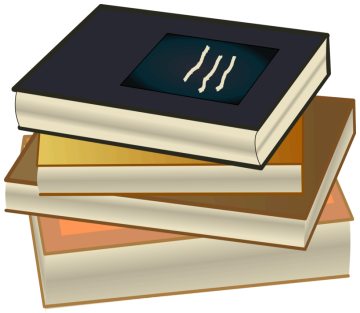


Uu

Short sound /uh/

Long sound /U/

u_e	c<u>ute</u>
ue	contin<u>ue</u>
eu	f<u>eu</u>d
u |	<u>u</u>nicorn



Uu

Short sound /uu/

Long sound /oo/

u_e	t<u>ube</u>
oo	b<u>oo</u>t
ew	n<u>ew</u>
ue	bl<u>ue</u>
ou	s<u>ou</u>p
ui	fr<u>ui</u>t
u |	r<u>u</u>ler

Vowel r

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ar /R/ c<u>ar</u>

or /or/ sh<u>or</u>t

er (ir/ur) /er/ h<u>er</u>, b<u>ir</u>d, n<u>ur</u>se

Dipthongs

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ai	r<u>ai</u>n
ay	s<u>ay</u>
oi	s<u>oi</u>l
oy	b<u>oy</u>
au	s<u>au</u>ce
aw	s<u>aw</u>
ou	m<u>ou</u>th
ow	c<u>ow</u>

Silent 

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1 - make short vowels long

2 - words cannot end with u or v

3 - added to l to make a
complete syllab<u>le</u>.

4 - change a consonant from
hard to soft (c and g)
or from unvoiced to voiced
(bath > bath<u>e</u>)

5 - it's not a plural word (nurs<u>e</u>)

ie/ei

The Core Rule (Long /ē/ Sound)

- **Use IE normally:** When the letters make a long /ē/ sound, *I* comes first.
    - believe, chief, piece, field
- **Use EI after C:** If a *C* comes right before the vowel team, *E* comes first.
    - ceiling, *receive*, *deceive*.

Common Exceptions (The "NEWS" Rule)

The rule only applies to the long /ē/ sound, and it has famous rule-breakers. A helpful trick to remember the most common exceptions for long /ē/ without a preceding *C* is **NEWS**:

- **N**either
- **E**ither
- **W**eird
- **S**eize
- *(Plus others like leisure and caffeine.)*

Other Sounds (When EI Doesn't Follow the Rule)

The *EI* combination makes completely different sounds that do not follow the "after C" rule:

- **Long /ā/ ("ay"):** *neighbor*, *weigh*
- **Long /ī/ ("eye"):** *height*
- **Short /ī/ or /ĕ/:** *forfeit*, *heifer*

G and C

Hard versus Soft Sounds

Hard	Soft
G - /g/	G - /j/
C - /k/	C - /s/

a - o - u	e - i - y
game	gem
guitar	giraffe
got	gym
can	cent
country	city
cup	cycle

tch and ch

-tch:

- 1 syllable, after a short vowel
  Ex: match, fetch, pitch

-ch:

- Beginning of a word
  Ex: chat, chip, chop

- After a consonant
  Ex: lunch, bench, church

- Long vowel/vowel team
  Ex: peach, beach, coach

- R-controlled vowels
  Ex: torch, arch

Ending /k/

-ck -k -c -ke

-ck: 1 syllable with a short vowel sound
Ex: duck, pick, lack

-k: 1 syllable, long vowel sound/vowel pair
Or
consonant
Ex: book weak or milk, tank

-c: 2 or more syllables *usually -ic
Ex: picnic, logic, dramatic

-ke: silent e, long vowel before /k/ sound
Ex: cake, bike, joke, cute, theme

FLOSS

-ff -ll -ss -zz

(Usually) double an f, l, s, or z that is:

- At the end of a word
- After a short vowel
- A single syllable word
- Not an action (runs, hops)
- Not plural (cats, dogs)

- **f exceptions:** *if, chef, clef*
- **l exceptions:** *pal, gal*
- **s exceptions:** *us, bus, gas, yes, plus, this, thus, as, is, has, was, his*
- **z exceptions:** *quiz*

/j/ Sound

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j g -ge -dge

j: beginning or middle, any vowel
Ex: jam, jet, enjoy

g: beginning or middle, with an e, i, or y
Ex: gym, gel, general

-ge: end of a word, after a long vowel or consonant
Ex: page, huge, large

-dge: end of a word, after a short vowel, one syllable word usually
Ex: badge, fridge, judge

Ending /s/

-s -es -ies -ves

-s: add s to most words

Ex: cats, phones, lamps

-es: add es to words ending in **s x ch sh x**

Ex: dresses, foxes, patches, brushes, buzzes

-ies: change if a words ends in **consonant-y**

Ex: flies, cherries

-ves: change if a words ends in **f** or **fe**

Ex: lives, wolves, knives

Exceptions: men, sheep, women, teeth, …